

AFFECTING AND BEING AFFECTED

Greetings and blessings for all of you present here, my dearest friends. We are all friends. There is a connection, a deep inner connection already manifest, and in some cases potentially there, on the plane of inner reality. In this latter instance where it is as yet only a potentiality, it is certainly possible to realize it. In this connection, our mutual aim is to truly find the core of your real being and to thus find your real existence. This real existence is light and beauty. In this real existence there is nothing to fear. The guidance I have given in all these years directs and helps you step by step to get through the maze of your illusions -- the maze of your illusory fears of life, of self, of being. All those steps you undertake in order to ward off the recognition of the experience of this illusory self alienates you so much farther from your nucleus, your true existence in bliss, in which you know there is nothing to fear. But you must go through the fear in order to find that it is illusion and in order to choose whether or not you wish to continue living in this illusion or to give it up. The latter requires some effort and willingness to change and chance some unknown modes of living and being, of reacting and acting.

Now, what is basically this fear, my friends? It exists in many forms and variations. Yet there is one common denominator, and that is that you fear the destructive and demonic aspects of temporary, distorted parts of your inner being. This is what your consciousness, in its separation, cannot reconcile itself to. This is what it cannot accept, what it does not know how to accept. The consciousness is fearful to be overwhelmed by the destructive energies just because it has never accepted them. Consciousness is too proud and too impatient, too much geared to limiting vision and thinking, in order to make room for all the opposites that exist within the human soul. And just because of the limiting tendency of consciousness, the opposites cannot be transcended. Only by full acceptance of the distortion can this distortion transform itself back to its original state -- into the beautiful, creative force that energizes you and gives you so much more power and bliss. As I said in many different ways over the years, there can be no way into blissful reality unless you give up the wishful thinking that makes you unwilling to face the irrational, destructive aspects of yourself.

This brings me to the topic of tonight's lecture. I would like to discuss particularly how you affect your surroundings from this destructive level of your being. How do you affect others? And, conversely, how are you being affected by others from their destructive parts. This is a very complicated and extremely important topic, which is not easy to comprehend. I would say the only way you can truly connect with this topic and make something helpful for yourself out of it is when you have already gained a certain amount of insight and have accepted some of the irrational, ignorant, destructive part of the childish, primitive self within you. When you come to the point when you no longer need to deny, project, and defend against this evil part; when you can clearly acknowledge it; then you can truly deal with the complications that arise out of human interaction on those concealed levels of your and other people's destructiveness and ignorance.

First of all, I would like to mention here a very basic confusion and pain that all mankind suffers from. Whether or not individuals are specifically aware of this conflict, it always exists. Again, the more aware of it you are and consequently the better you can face it and deal with it, the sooner you will resolve it. This conflict is the following: on the primitive, irrational level, you hate and want to destroy senselessly and hardly know any longer why you hate and want to destroy. On this level you are totally egotistical and therefore unwilling to accept any frustration, little or big. Here you are unwilling to deal with any difficulties, and therefore you cannot meaningfully and effectively assert your personality. Whatever the reasons may be, this irrational hate and wish to destroy exists in every single human being.

You manage not to be aware of your hate and destructiveness, and that is the root of all emotional sickness and suffering. As you progress through the discipline of self-facing, you become more aware, accept that aspect, and thus transcend it. As you become thus aware, you also have to deal specifically with the confusion of your guilt. Hidden guilt is very devastating. It creates a vicious circle by itself that maintains the destructiveness. The guiltier you feel, the more you hide whatever makes you feel guilty and the less you become capable of dissolving and transforming it. This incapacity in turn increases the guilt. Alongside of this, the more you hide from yourself, the more you frustrate yourself and deprive yourself of the good that life is meant to be. Thus you become angrier, more hating, and more destructive. Even if this does not manifest in overt acts, your so-called unconscious guilt leads you into manifest hating actions and attitudes that reject others and life and the goodness of being.

Now, how is this guilt to be handled? There are two basic schools of thought that have existed throughout the ages on this earth sphere. The one says that you are not responsible for your feelings and unmanifest attitudes. You are only responsible for your actions and deeds. So, if you hate and wish to kill and destroy, to be spiteful and malicious, you do not need to feel guilty about it.

The other school of thought says that thoughts and attitudes are living realities and have their effect on others. That would then mean that a true guilt exists for these thoughts and attitudes. Also, we must consider the question whether the hidden tendency to be destructive can leave deeds and actions totally unaffected. I just said that it is unthinkable for hidden hate not to manifest in some way, even if the personality refrains from active deeds. It is a deed, too, if one holds back from loving and giving. Every so often, the denied hatred manifests in an apparently harmless passivity that seems directed against the self "only." But the underlying seething hatred prevents positive deeds of loving and giving, it prevents one from contributing to life. So, in the final analysis, all acts and deeds flow from the underlying substance and energy of the person.

These two, apparently opposite schools of thought, or modes of approaching life, the world, yourself, and others exist in everyone and breed a great deal of confusion. Which is true? How do you handle this question? Before we can go any further regarding the mutual interaction on the destructive levels between human beings, this question must first be cleared up. How could it be that both alternatives are true, valid, and not mutually exclusive?

It is absolutely true that guilt for your primitive destructive self is more destructive than the evil part itself. It is true that you must accept in order to dissolve. It is also true that there is a vast difference between an overt action of destruction and the mental and emotional existence of this

aspect in humankind. This is true in spite of what I said before about the definite effects and influences of hidden attitudes. Yet to assume a self-destructive, self-eroding guilt about them adds insult to injury; it makes matters so much worse. In this guilt you annihilate yourself and become more destructive. You prohibit yourself from living.

Nevertheless it is truly a reality that your thoughts and feelings, your wishes and attitudes have power. Now, the reconciliation of these two apparent opposites lies in one fact only, and that is your honest attempts to make your own destructiveness conscious without justifying it with the destructiveness or limitation of others. The moment you do this, you inactivate destructiveness without denying or hiding it. When you deny your hate and malice, your egotism and spite, you breed trouble -- for yourself and others. The denial of the demon in you creates very damaging effects. For example, in the denial, you need to blame and accuse so as to make others responsible for what you feel too guilty about facing squarely. You, who work so diligently on this path, have verified this again and again in how you fall into the temptation to build cases, to use others' actual or imaginary evil so as to deny your own. You distort and exaggerate in order to falsify. You deal with half-truths, for what you use as your case may at times harbor elements of actual evil in others. It is untrue, however, to make them responsible for your misery. This is one of the most profound manifestations of denying self-responsibility and nurturing a dependent attitude. In effect, you say, "I am dependent on the other's evil or on his freedom from it."

It is not difficult to see the bind that this puts you in. If on a semiconscious level you express this message into life, on a deeper level of your unconscious you must pay the price and follow through. You must then also express into life, "My evil is responsible for the suffering of others." Thus, you fluctuate between infantile dependency in which you are under the illusion that you are helpless in the face of the other's wrongdoing and, at the same time, omnipotent in the responsibility that this attitude imposes upon you. Others are victimized by your incompleteness.

Conversely, the moment you fully assume responsibility for your own suffering by looking for your own evil attitudes, your own distortions and destructive tendencies regardless of how wrong others may be, you liberate yourself from guilt. You will know from personal experience that, as you can be affected by others only to the degree you refute and ignore your own negativities, so can others be affected by yours only to the degree they refute theirs.

The capacity to acknowledge your own irrational self without totally becoming it renders you free. The need to concentrate on the ills of others is a destructive act in itself. It makes it impossible to really fight the evil in you. I do not mean to convey, however, that you should assume the sole responsibility and falsely whitewash the other person. Whenever there is negative interaction, both must share the responsibility. But to concentrate and measure, to compare and emotionally victimize yourself, is tantamount to the denial of your own part even if you pay lip service to knowing that you must also contribute to the interaction. What invariably happens when you look for your own contribution is that, in the end, you see how you both affect one another from the destructive levels. You truly share the responsibility. This realization is extremely liberating. It frees you from eroding guilt without, however, removing the responsibility that is yours. It enables you to see and express the other person's share in the mutual effect without becoming the accusing, self-victimizing judge. This has a very salutary effect and usually makes your expressions effective if the other person is at all willing. In case he is not, this will no longer present a debilitating frustration for you. You no longer depend on proving your innocence. You see and

know the truth. The cleanliness of this knowledge makes you very strong and dissolves negative energy. When you hide your evil behind the evil of others, you invariably become weak and your fight is ineffective. Effective fight, healthy aggression becomes possible only when you no longer hide from yourself, from your own honest insight, when you no longer wish to cover up your destructiveness, when you cease to be hypocritical on this most subtle of levels.

So you see, my friends, both these schools of thought are true. These apparent opposite orientations are reconciled by the key I am constantly recommending to you: face your evil, your irrationality, your primitive destructive aspects without losing sight that this is only a minor aspect of you. If you completely identify with this hidden part, it is impossible to live and assume responsibility for it. Yet, the more you hide it, the more you secretly believe that this is your real self, your only truth. When you take it out of hiding, the wonderful reality dawns upon you that there is so much more to you than you have secretly given yourself credit for. In using this key, you cannot act out the evil, directly or indirectly. You cannot spread evil. The evil thoughts, feelings, and wishes can be dealt with in a direct and effective way when they are acknowledged. The moment you deny them, poison is emanated from you onto others, and it spreads in your own psychic and physical system.

This shows, once again, in a very clear-cut example that you can verify every day of your life if you truly look at your interactions in your relationships, that the key to life is the honest acknowledgment of your primitive, destructive part. This key will finally open the gates that make you capable of sustaining the bliss of the real world, which tries to communicate itself constantly to you and which you must ward off fearfully and/or blindly as long as these areas of your being have not been acknowledged, as long as you fearfully deny and resist your negativity.

Let us now discuss how you affect others from your positive, self-realized, purified levels of being as well as from your negative levels. The clear, free, liberated, purified levels where you are constructive and creative, where you are in truth and loving, where you want to give of yourself and are, at the same time, strong and self-assertive and do not permit the other person's destructiveness to impinge upon you have a very strong effect on your surroundings. The effect exists on all levels. On the overt, manifest level of actions, deeds, words, you will have a particular strength, direct influence for the good, and you will set an example although your strength will, at times, be misunderstood. Those who cannot render you responsible for their suffering, when they pin their evil on you, will not be successful because you have learned to face your destructive self. This may, at times, cause resentments, but in the long run it will have a very purifying effect. On the unconscious levels, the energies that emanate from you will have an even stronger effect. Your pure energy can penetrate the fog and murkiness and can disperse the poison. Thus it happens that such a free person can by-pass evil layers and reach directly beyond them, activating the best in the other person. This may give this other person an inkling of what he can be, so that he will no longer have to hide from himself.

To whatever degree you are thus liberated, the effect is immense. You affect the equally liberated levels of inner existence, of psychic reality of others so that a wonderful, marvelous energy is increasingly generated. This energy multiplies and multiplies and multiplies and reaches out, uniting with other similarly constituted energy streams. It takes on more momentum. It seeps through the muddiness and murkiness and darkness that the negativities create. It can effectively penetrate the poisonous walls of separation created by error, ignorance, lies, illusion, malice, hatred.

To the degree this liberated level is strong, to that degree it has power to dissolve evil -- in self and others. And you now know what this strength in you depends on: the key of acknowledgment of irrational destruction in you. The strength depends on the degree you are doing this constantly.

When you are in an in-between state, when it fluctuates because at times you use this key but in some areas you refrain from doing so, there will be a fluctuating battle between you and others on the unconscious levels. Where your liberated state is still weak, it may succumb to the ferocity of accusation and blame of the other person -- perhaps purely unspoken and unconscious -- because this other person is still "strong" in denial of self- responsibility and has artificially aggrandized his self-righteous accusation. In other instances and relationships, your liberated true strength may have the greater effect and win over the already weakened negative self of others, whose projections and accusations may not be counteracted if you are yourself in the state of denial and accusation, but can easily be counteracted when you are freed to only a lesser degree by dint of using the great key of life under discussion here.

So, you see, the degrees and variations are as infinite as there exist human states of consciousness. When two people's unconscious levels affect each other, all the varying, fluctuating states of both must be taken into account, and, at any given moment, whatever becomes the predominant overall "result" is determined by whatever degree the key of life is used or not used by either or both. Warfare and mutual destruction is the final outcome of two entities (nations or individuals) not using the key. The more you use this key and stop hiding behind the ills of others, the more you will strengthen your whole being and enable the real self to manifest, you will combine with the liberated aspects of others, you will affect them, you will encourage it in others, while it will transcend the negativities of others, helping them to experience their real self beyond those negativities. Thus a new feeling of self is being born -- the knowledge that the negative self is not the only reality. This interchange will take place, not necessarily by what you say, but by how you affect their being. Also, what you say will have a different impact. How you say it, how you act, how you feel to others will be absolutely determined by your strength of meeting your own negativities. In that way you spread good.

It is entirely obvious that your unrecognized, unadmitted, projected, denied destructiveness immediately affects the counterpart in others. Mutual accusation, self-righteous blaming, compulsion to build a case -- all these evasive tactics build and built the negative interaction, the strife and conflict, the pain and confusion.

Now, let us reverse the process. How are you being affected by others? Quite a few human beings live in a certain amount of harmony and strength, have worked their way through sufficiently to no longer initially spread destructiveness. Most human beings, in their current phase of development, are still in the state of fearful defense against living, even when there is no cause for it and when they are in touch with those who are ready to give them love and help. Thus they spread evil by virtue of their being closed up to truth and love, to giving and receiving. But a number of developed human beings are no longer in this state and are, as I said, free enough to give out the best of themselves, undefended. However, this does not yet make them immune to being affected by the destructiveness of others. They may be very easily affected by the unconscious negative thoughts and feelings, the polluted energy of other people, and are thus victimized and dependent. It is as though they expressed into life: "I demand perfection around me so that I can remain in what I have gained, so that I can remain in my clarified, blissful state." When this is still the case, a lot

more progress must be made, for the true immunity comes only when this dependency no longer exists, when the other person's negativity can no longer affect you. When it does affect you, there must be self-doubt and guilt in you as result of not having faced all your confusions and destructive impulses, all your irrational and illusory aspects. No matter how much you have done this, there are still unclear areas, for otherwise you would not be so vulnerable and so affected by the others' perhaps much more obvious ills. This means you must still return to this earth life and live in this sphere of duality where you must battle with the opposites -- pleasure and pain, life and death, good and evil. You cannot transcend these opposites as long as the key of life is not used.

When you are so affected by others' negativities, you must truly explore what makes you so vulnerable. I venture to say this dependency and vulnerability on the psychic level must be a correspondence to a psychological refutation of self-responsibility and insistence to blame life or others for your misery. There must be some area in which you are not honestly meeting yourself. For if you do, if you wholly and completely do, the negative energy and emanation of others will be totally ineffective on you. You will not need to build your false defenses where everything reverberates and nothing comes through to you. This is, after all, one of the reasons these defenses are being built: to ward off the pain of other people's cruelty, hostility, meanness, the unjustified demands they make upon the world, therefore also on you. You may be quite conscious of this fear, but you only gradually begin to explore and find out that these defenses ward off everything and anything that life has to give so abundantly. Thus these defenses are to your detriment. They prohibit the good of life to come into you and the best of you to come out into life, filling you with the best there is -- your own good feelings. This is made impossible by these unconscious and debilitating defenses.

When these defenses are being abandoned, you can melt with life, melt with the psychic substances of others, where exchanges of love, exchanges of truth, can take place. This universal truth manifests with all individuals in their own unique way. This variety gives living a special excitement without disrupting deep inner peace. The flow of interchange enriches you so deeply that there are no words to describe it. It is the exact opposite way of living that accrues from being encased in your defensive walls which completely separate you and create great loneliness. These defenses create a very unhappy existence, a very dependent, limited, and suffering existence!

On the other hand, you cannot live completely vulnerably exposed, as you are now when you have not explored those levels of your being where you blame others for their evil because you shy away from facing your own. In this state you must be extremely vulnerable -- which might be rationalized by a prideful claim of being "so sensitive." But this sensitivity is not a sign of a unique individuality in the divine sense. It is a distortion in itself and not necessary. In this state, everything must hurt and penetrate you. If you do not avail yourself with vigor of the key I hand you again and again, you absolutely need your destructive defenses that shut you out of life.

It is your task to find a mode of being in which you are adequately defended, not sickly defended; realistically defended, not unrealistically. This realistic and adequate defense against being adversely affected by the evil of others is the total meeting of our own evil -- the daily, renewed determination to do so. The signs are always there; the helpful hints that life offers you are your gauges. They consist in your anxious, angry, confused reactions -- perhaps first you know not what. If you refrain from habitual pushing aside of what disturbs you and rationalizing it, you may first find that you are upset about what others do to you. It may seem or be an injustice. But do not

remain on that level where you talk yourself into it, convincing yourself that this justifies and explains your disturbance. When you resist this temptation and go beyond it, you are heeding life's lesson and sign.

One day lived in a blissful state, in which you are alive and deeply in contact with your innermost being and thus with the whole universe, emanating joy and having truly deep and meaningful exchanges with others in which you do not have to ward off life from within and without, will make you know that on that day you have not defended against anything. But also, possibly you were fortunate on that day to come into the psychic circumference of strong, clear, liberated spiritual energy and consciousness. No unconscious destructiveness of others came your way. Such negative influx is not directed against you because you are you, but simply because you are another human being and represent "the enemy."

If the reason for the bliss is the latter, are you truly safe and free? Are you not still in a dependent state and thus inevitably anxious whether or not you experience this anxiety and distrust at all times? The answer is obvious. You must surge on in order to become wholly yourself, and therefore no longer in need of destructive defenses that ward you off and shift responsibility for your state onto others.

Most days offer opportunities to do this. The many reactions of discomfort you register should be taken more into your field of vision. They harbor the clue. Whatever your reactions to others may be, reactions that do not make you quite glad with yourself and others, they should be examined. These reactions and incidents that come to you are the reminders that the greatest therapist of all extends to you -- life itself. There is something for you to see and find that you have not truly recognized: why are you so vulnerable? If you heed the sign for what it is, heed the pain or the discomfort that you suffer now and decide with all the vigor and determination of your courageous self, "I want to see that part in me that is responsible for being affected by another's evil," then you cannot fail to discover it and be more liberated and more secure than ever.

Unfortunately, again and again, the temptation to concentrate and focus on the other person's shortcomings, evil, or ill sets you off from where you should be. Whatever you see in others may or may not be correct, as the case may be. You will truly have peace and clarity about it only when you heed the sign and fully understand why you are vulnerable and exposed to the real or imagined negativities and destructiveness of others.

I cannot emphasize strongly enough the need to make use of this key. I would like to say here to you, my friends, that those of you who pursue this very taxing but very real pathwork will find this true undefended, open, flowing state of security, bliss, and peace. The path is so taxing because it leaves no room for projection and escapes, no matter how hard it is tried. Some fall by the wayside because they are not yet, in this incarnation, willing to go all the way with themselves and rather dwell on blame. But those of you who follow me all the way cannot help but find the truth of being. It cannot be denied that precisely because this path allows no escape, the path is a hard taskmaster. It dispenses with all sentimentality that encourages your weakness and self-evasions. But because of this, it keeps the promise it makes, as more of you begin to actually find out and literally experience. The finding of your real values is possible only when the courage is mastered to find your evil, distorted aspects. You must and will find your true capacity to love and be loved -- not as a concept, thought, or ideal, not as an illusion but as an actually experienced reality in your

everyday life. These are not empty promises and far away ideals. These are the promises that life makes and holds for him who uses the key of life on this plane of existence. The more you do this, the less you will be in need to defend yourself against pain and therefore against the bliss of life, the gift of life, that comes to you at all times.

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